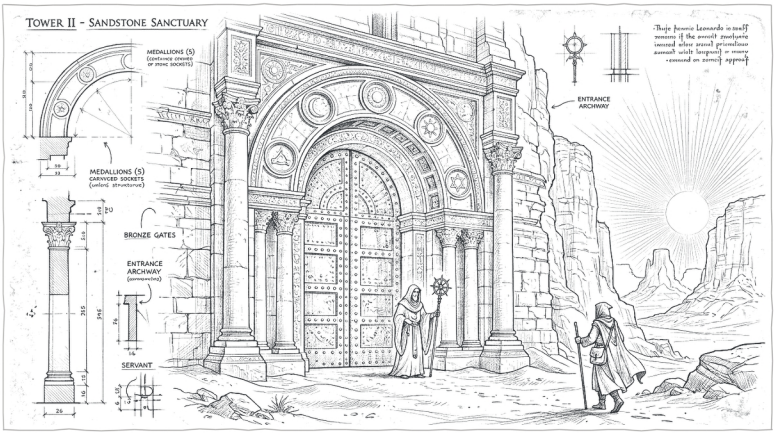
At the Gates of Tower II

I. The Sandstone Sanctuary

At the western margin of the salt playa rise the colossal ramparts of Tower II. Here, carved deep into the sheer red cliffs, stands the Sandstone Sanctuary of the Oracle. Fluted columns of living rock frame an ancient archway sealed by heavy bronze gates. In the shadow of the portico stands the Sanctuary Servant, an elder of the Order guarding the threshold with an iron staff topped by a celestial star-sight. Along the lintel, in worn capitals, the founders cut their rule: «OPEN AT THE SETTING OF THE SUN».



II. The Demand of the Five Seals

No traveler may step beyond the gates without offering proof of their survey. When I presented the carved stone seal recovered from the dry riverbed, the guardian studied its geometry in silence, then pointed his staff to the five empty sockets set into the arch: «You have found the first seal by following the dry wash, but four still sleep in stone. Five sacred cairns were raised by our founders to measure this desert. Return to the sands and complete the meridian survey, or these gates remain closed forever.»

III. The Great Circuit



Cairn I	Cairn II	Cairn III	Cairn IV	Cairn V
Seal acquired	Seal missing	Seal missing	Seal missing	Seal missing
River Wash	Sun Monolith	Sandstone Labyrinth	Canyon Sentry	Solar Altar Arch

The initial hunch by the dry wash was only the first link. To unlock the Sanctuary and stand before the Oracle, we must traverse the full expanse of the Grand Desert Map and recover each missing seal from its landmark. Our course is set north-north-east, toward the shadow of the Sun Monolith.